

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ
بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 39

La un Nafi al-Jins

1. The definition of La un Nafi al-Jins

Definition: *La un Nafi al-Jins* is the particle that negates **every kind** of what is stated in the Khabar of its noun. It comes for **absolute negation**; that is, whatever thing or genus it enters upon, it denies outright the ruling that applies to that genus.

La un Nafi al-Jins is used at the head of a *Jumla Ismiyyah*, and it takes the two basic parts of the *Jumla Ismiyyah* — the *Mubtada* and the *Khabar* — as **its own noun** and **its own Khabar** respectively.

The ruling on its noun: The noun of *La un Nafi al-Jins* is always **Nakirah** and **Mabni 'ala al-Fathah**.

لَا رَجُلَ قَائِمٌ

(no man at all is standing)

Element	Details
لَا	La un Nafi al-Jins
رَجُلَ	the noun of La un Nafi al-Jins
قَائِمٌ	the Khabar of La un Nafi al-Jins

Three ways of rendering it

- no ____ at all
- there is no such thing as ____
- not any ____ whatever

2. The three forms of its noun

The noun of *La un Nafi al-Jins* comes in three forms.

Form	Definition	Example
Mufrad	in grammatical terminology mufrad means a single standing word, whether it be singular, dual or plural	لَا رَجُلَ قَائِمٌ
Mudaf	a noun after which a Mudaf Ilayh comes	لَا صَاحِبَ عِلْمٍ مَذْمُومٌ
Shibh Mudaf	a noun that needs another word to complete its meaning	لَا ظَالِمًا جَبَلًا حَاضِرٌ

An important point: In the Qur'an the noun of *La un Nafi al-Jins* is used **only in the mufrad form**; its use as a *Mudaf* or a *Shibh Mudaf* is not found.

The difference in I'raab: The *mufrad* noun is *Mabni 'ala al-Fathah* and comes with a **single fathah**. But as a *Mudaf* or a *Shibh Mudaf* the noun is **Mansoob in wording** and takes the *Tanween* of *nasb*, that is, two fathahs, as may be seen in the second and third examples above.

3. The mufrad noun and its I'raab

When the noun of *La un Nafi al-Jins* is *mufrad*, it comes with a single fathah. In the reckoning of the grammarians it is *Mabni 'ala al-Fathah* and is counted as *mahallan Mansoob*.

The reason: An ordinary *Mansoob Munsarif* noun comes with **two fathahs**, that is, with the *Tanween* of *nasb*. But the *mufrad* noun of *La un Nafi al-Jins* always comes with a **single fathah**. That is why it is called *Mabni 'ala al-Fathah* and *mahallan Mansoob*.

The state of the Khabar

The *Khabar* of *La un Nafi al-Jins* is sometimes stated openly and sometimes **omitted**. In the Qur'an it is most often found omitted, and in its place there comes a *jarr* with its *majroor*, or a *zarf*, which is related to the Khabar.

This rule was met before: This very principle of the *Khabar* being omitted and a *jarr* with its *majroor* or a *zarf* standing in its place was studied in Lectures 33 and 34 under the name *Qa'im Maqam Khabar*.

4. Examples from the Qur'an

4.1 La rayba feehi

ذَٰلِكَ الْكِتَابُ لَا رَيْبَ ۚ فِيهِ ۚ هُدًى لِّلْمُتَّقِينَ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 2)

Translation: This is the Book in which there is no doubt whatever, a guidance for those mindful of Allah.

Element	Details
لَا	La un Nafi al-Jins
رَيْبَ	its noun, which is Mabni 'ala al-Fathah and mahallan Mansoob
فِيهِ	a jarr with its majroor, standing in the place of the Khabar; the real Khabar is omitted

Two ways of rendering it: "in it there is not the least doubt", or "there is no doubt in it at all". *La un Nafi al-Jins* joins with its noun and its Khabar to make a complete *Jumla Ismiyyah*.

4.2 Fa-la ansaba baynahum

فَإِذَا نُفِخَ فِي الصُّورِ فَلَا أَنْسَابَ بَيْنَهُمْ يَوْمَئِذٍ وَلَا يَتَسَاءَلُونَ

(Surah al-Mu'minun: 101)

Translation: Then when the Trumpet is blown, there will be no ties of kinship among them that day, nor will they ask about one another.

Element	Details
لَا	La un Nafi al-Jins
أَنْسَابَ	a Jam' Mukassar, which has become its noun with a single fathah; the Khabar is omitted
بَيْنَهُمْ	a zarf with its Mudaf Ilayh, standing in the place of the Khabar

This example proves that the *mufrad* noun of *La un Nafi al-Jins* may also be a plural, because in grammar *mufrad* means a single standing word, not a singular.

4.3 La ikraha fid-deen

لَا إِكْرَاهَ فِي الدِّينِ ۚ قَدْ تَبَيَّنَ الرُّشْدُ مِنَ الْغَيِّ ۚ فَمَنْ يَكْفُرْ بِالطَّاغُوتِ وَيُؤْمِنْ بِاللَّهِ فَقَدِ اسْتَمْسَكَ بِالْعُرْوَةِ الْوُثْقَىٰ لَا انْفِصَامَ لَهَا ۗ وَاللَّهُ سَمِيعٌ عَلِيمٌ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 256)

Translation: There is no compulsion in religion. Right guidance has become distinct from error. So whoever rejects false deities and believes in Allah has grasped the firmest handhold, which never breaks. And Allah is all-hearing, all-knowing.

In this single verse *La un Nafi al-Jins* occurs **twice**.

Element	Details
لَا إِكْرَاهَ	إِكْرَاهَ is the noun of La un Nafi al-Jins and فِي الدِّينِ its Khabar — that is, there is no such thing as compulsion in religion
لَا انْفِصَامَ	انْفِصَامَ is the noun of La un Nafi al-Jins and لَهَا its Khabar — that is, there is no breaking of it at all

4.4 La 'asima al-yawm

قَالَ سَاوِيٌّ إِلَىٰ جَبَلٍ يَّغْصِمُنِي مِنَ الْمَاءِ ۖ قَالَ لَا عَاصِمَ الْيَوْمَ مِنْ أَمْرِ اللَّهِ إِلَّا مَنْ رَحِمَ ۚ وَحَالَ بَيْنَهُمَا الْمَوْجُ فَكَانَ مِنَ الْمَغْرِقِينَ

(Surah Hud: 43)

Translation: He said: I shall take refuge on a mountain that will save me from the water. He said: today there is no protector from the decree of Allah, except for him on whom He has mercy. And the wave came between them, so he was among the drowned.

When Nuh, peace be upon him, told his son to board the ark and the son answered that he would take refuge on a mountain, the Prophet said: لَا عَاصِمَ الْيَوْمَ.

Element	Details
لَا	La un Nafi al-Jins
عَاصِمَ	the noun of La un Nafi al-Jins
الْيَوْمَ	a zarf standing in the place of the Khabar

That is: today there is no protector whatever from the punishment of Allah.

4.5 Three nouns together

الْحَجُّ أَشْهُرٌ مَّعْلُومَاتٌ ۚ فَمَنْ فَرَضَ فِيهِنَّ الْحَجَّ فَلَا رَفَثَ وَلَا فُسُوقَ وَلَا جِدَالَ فِي الْحَجِّ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 197)

Translation: Hajj is in the well-known months. So whoever undertakes Hajj in them, there is no lewd speech, no wrongdoing and no quarrelling during Hajj.

Here رَفَثَ, فُسُوقَ and جِدَالَ are all three nouns of *La un Nafi al-Jins*, each preceded by لَا, and فِي الْحَجِّ, a *Murakkab Jarri*, is their Khabar.

4.6 La tathreeba 'alaykum al-yawm

قَالَ لَا تَثْرِيبَ عَلَيْكُمُ الْيَوْمَ يَغْفِرُ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ وَهُوَ أَرْحَمُ الرَّحِيمِينَ

(Surah Yusuf: 92)

Translation: He said: no blame is upon you today. May Allah forgive you, and He is the most merciful of the merciful.

A point of history: These are the very words the Prophet, peace be upon him, spoke to the people of Makkah on the day of its conquest, saying that he said to them today what Yusuf, peace be upon him, had said to his brothers.

5. The Kalimah Tayyibah and well-known remembrances

The finest and greatest example of *La un Nafi al-Jins* is the *Kalimah Tayyibah*.

لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ

(there is no god at all except Allah)

Element	Details
لَا	La un Nafi al-Jins
إِلَهَ	the noun of La un Nafi al-Jins, while its Khabar is omitted

La hawla wa la quwwata illa billah

لَا حَوْلَ وَلَا قُوَّةَ إِلَّا بِاللَّهِ

Here حَوْلَ and قُوَّةَ are both nouns of *La un Nafi al-Jins*.

From the hadith

سَبْعَةٌ يُظِلُّهُمْ اللَّهُ فِي ظِلِّهِ يَوْمَ لَا ظِلَّ إِلَّا ظِلُّهُ

Translation: Seven whom Allah will shade in His shade on the day when there is no shade but His shade.

Here in لَا ظِلَّ, لَا is *La un Nafi al-Jins* and ظِلَّ its noun, by which every kind of shade other than the shade of Allah is negated on that day.

The du'a after the obligatory prayer

اللَّهُمَّ لَا مَانِعَ لِمَا أَعْطَيْتَ وَلَا مُعْطِيَ لِمَا مَنَعْتَ وَلَا يَنْفَعُ ذَا الْجَدِّ مِنْكَ الْجَدُّ

Translation: O Allah, there is none who can withhold what You give, and none who can give what You withhold.

لَا مُعْطِيَ and لَا مَانِعَ — in both *La un Nafi al-Jins* is used, where مَانِعَ means one who withholds and مُعْطِيَ one who gives.

6. Another way of producing force in a sentence

We say "the one worthy of worship is Allah" — and this is a plain statement. But when we say "none is worthy of worship except Allah", the statement remains the same yet the tone of the speech changes.

The Arabic pattern: Arabic conveys this very sense through the pattern: ____ لَا ____ إِلَّا ____

Arabic	Translation
لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ	there is no god at all, except Allah
لَا حَوْلَ وَلَا قُوَّةَ إِلَّا بِاللَّهِ	there is no power to turn away from evil and no strength to do good, except by Allah

The benefit of this pattern is that *La un Nafi al-Jins* first negates the whole genus, and then through **إِلَّا** a single one is excepted. In this way the utmost degree of force and decisiveness enters the statement.

7. The three particles compared

Three ways of negating or emphasising a *Jumla Ismiyyah* have now been studied. It is most useful to see the difference between them at a glance.

Particle	Its noun	Its Khabar	Its sense
إِنَّ	Ma'rifah, Mansoob	Nakirah, Marfoo'	emphasis — "indeed"
Ma al-Hijaziyyah	Ma'rifah, Marfoo'	Nakirah, Mansoob	negation of one particular thing — "is not"
La un Nafi al-Jins	Nakirah, Mabni 'ala al-Fathah	Nakirah, Marfoo' (often omitted)	negation of the whole genus — "none at all"

The most important difference

Ma al-Hijaziyyah and La un Nafi al-Jins: *Ma al-Hijaziyyah* negates the ruling of **one determinate individual** — مَا زَيْدٌ قَائِمًا, that is, Zayd is not standing, though someone else may be. Whereas *La un Nafi al-Jins* negates the ruling of **the whole genus** — لَا رَجُلٌ قَائِمٌ, that is, no man at all is standing.

Why is the noun Nakirah?: The noun of *La un Nafi al-Jins* is *Nakirah* precisely so that the negation may relate to the whole genus. Were the noun *Ma'rifah*, the negation would be confined to one determinate thing, and the very purpose of "negating the genus" would be lost.

Summary

1. La un Nafi al-Jins is the particle that negates every kind of what is stated in the Khabar of its noun.
2. It comes for absolute negation; whatever genus it enters upon, it denies outright the ruling applying to it.
3. It comes at the head of a Jumla Ismiyyah and takes the Muftada and Khabar as its own noun and Khabar.
4. Its noun is always Nakirah and Mabni 'ala al-Fathah.
5. It is rendered "no ____ at all", "there is no such thing as ____", or "not any ____ whatever".
6. Its noun comes in three forms: muftad, Mudaf and Shibh Mudaf.
7. In grammatical terminology muftad means a single standing word, whether singular, dual or plural.
8. A Shibh Mudaf is a noun that needs another word to complete its meaning.
9. In the Qur'an the noun of La un Nafi al-Jins comes only in the muftad form.
10. The muftad noun comes with a single fathah, which is why it is called Mabni 'ala al-Fathah and mahallan Mansoob.
11. An ordinary Mansoob Munsarif noun comes with two fathahs, which is why one with a single fathah is reckoned Mabni.
12. The Khabar of La un Nafi al-Jins is sometimes stated and sometimes omitted; in the Qur'an it is most often omitted.
13. Where the Khabar is omitted, a jarr with its majroor or a zarf comes in its place, related to the Khabar.
14. In **لَا رَيْبَ فِيهِ**, **رَيْبَ** is the noun and **فِيهِ** has come in the place of the Khabar.
15. In **فَلَا أَنْسَابَ بَيْنَهُمْ**, **أَنْسَابَ** has become the noun with a single fathah despite being a Jam' Mukassar.
16. In verse 256 of Surah al-Baqarah, La un Nafi al-Jins occurs twice: **لَا أَنْفِصَامَ** and **لَا إِكْرَاهَ**.
17. In **لَا عَاصِمَ الْيَوْمَ**, **عَاصِمَ** is the noun and **الْيَوْمَ** a zarf in the place of the Khabar.
18. In verse 197 of Surah al-Baqarah three nouns come together: **جَدَالٍ**, **رَفَثٍ**, **فُسُوقٍ**.
19. **لَا تَثْرِيْبَ عَلَيْكُمْ الْيَوْمَ** are the very words the Prophet spoke on the conquest of Makkah.
20. The Kalimah Tayyibah **لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ** is the greatest example of La un Nafi al-Jins, and its Khabar is omitted.
21. In **لَا حَوْلَ وَلَا قُوَّةَ إِلَّا بِاللَّهِ**, both **حَوْلَ** and **قُوَّةَ** are its nouns.
22. One Arabic style for producing force is the pattern: **لَا ____ إِلَّا ____**.
23. In it the whole genus is first negated, and then through **إِلَّا** a single one is excepted.
24. Ma al-Hijaziyyah negates the ruling of one determinate individual, while La un Nafi al-Jins negates that of the whole genus.
25. That is why the noun of Ma al-Hijaziyyah is Ma'rifah and Marfoo', while the noun of La un Nafi al-Jins is Nakirah and Mabni 'ala al-Fathah.

Exercise

1. Define La un Nafi al-Jins and state what it negates.
 2. State the ruling on its noun and its Khabar.
 3. Write all three ways of rendering it.
 4. Write all three forms of its noun with definitions and examples.
 5. What is meant by mufrad in grammatical terminology?
 6. Why is the mufrad noun called Mabni 'ala al-Fathah and mahallan Mansoob?
 7. What difference in l'raab arises when the noun is a Mudaf or a Shibh Mudaf?
 8. Write two points about the Khabar of La un Nafi al-Jins.
 9. Give a full analysis of لَا رَيْبَ فِيهِ.
 10. Which important rule is proved by فَلَا أَنْسَابَ بَيْنَهُمْ?
 11. Take out both places from verse 256 of Surah al-Baqarah and state the noun and Khabar of each.
 12. Write the background and analysis of لَا عَاصِمَ الْيَوْمَ.
 13. Write the three nouns of La un Nafi al-Jins in verse 197 of Surah al-Baqarah and their shared Khabar.
 14. Give the grammatical analysis of the Kalimah Tayyibah.
 15. Separate the nouns in لَا حَوْلَ وَلَا قُوَّةَ إِلَّا بِاللَّهِ.
 16. Take out both places from the du'a said after the obligatory prayer.
 17. Explain the pattern لَا ____ إِلَّا ____ and state its benefit.
 18. Set out a comparison of إِنَّ, Ma al-Hijaziyyah and La un Nafi al-Jins in a table.
 19. What is the most important difference between Ma al-Hijaziyyah and La un Nafi al-Jins? Explain with examples.
 20. Why is the noun of La un Nafi al-Jins Nakirah?
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سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ